

## AMD BULLDOZER MADNESS

Many seem to be disappointed with AMD's newest kid on the block a.k.a. Bulldozer. Something, somewhere has gone wrong. The benchmark scores are not up to the mark apart from other issues. Some say it's not worth an upgrade. Can Bulldozer overcome this troubling debut ?  
<http://bit.ly/rdonCS>

## BEST SCI-FI AND FANTASY BOOKS

Navigate your way through this highly informative and cool infographic which gives you the top 100 sci-fi and fantasy books of all time. The best thing is that this infographic would recommend you books depending on your mood for your reading pleasure.  
<http://bit.ly/p64CBc>

## IPHONE 4S VS CANON 5D MARK II

If the above title makes you go "whaaat ?" then maybe it's time to compare an iPhone's camera to a high-end Canon 5D Mark II. Both the devices put up on rigs and shot the exact same scene at 30 FPS. Which one fared better? Check it out here:  
<http://cnet.co/oTDs6x>

## 34 BEST WEBCOMICS FOR GEEKS

If you want to start off with webcomics, but don't know which ones are good, then check out this neat article which outlines 34 of the best webcomics for all you geeks out there.  
<http://bit.ly/p9S9az>



be sure. Also added is the "full site" button, where a user can switch the site being looked at to full desktop mode and back to the mobile version. Incognito tabs have been added to the browser as well. Last but certainly not least, the Android team has implemented a swipe-to-dismiss for open tabs functionality. With one press of a button, all available tabs are listed in a visual scrolling list, allowing for a simple finger swipe to close a desired tab.

**Interface improvements in multitasking and app closure:** This is a feature that fits both in the Honeycomb ports to ICS and in the new additions and it borrows heavily in the visual department, but adds the swipe-to-dismiss feature.

Android 4.0 has a multitasking button that brings up all your recent apps right where you left off, just like with Honeycomb. The big difference is that a user can actually dismiss and close an app with a finger swipe, just like in the browser.

**Productivity app improvements:** Gmail and Google Calendar were both highlighted as having some useful updates. In Gmail, the resolution of the screen allows for a two-line preview of received emails, making it easier to prioritize information. Offline search has been added, giving much more power to the mobile device to find an older message. Also integrated into Gmail is the new "People" app.

The big improvement to Google Calendar is the ability to pinch-to-zoom to expand the information displayed on the screen. From a month long calendar it is now possible to zoom into the info, making it much more useful.

**Contacts and social networking improvements:** Google has streamlined your contacts with 4.0. Now, all information on a contact is drawn from the social network connections made with them, as well as any custom info that you define. The Android team has named this functionality

"People," which looks very reminiscent of Windows Phone 7. Each contact gets a visual information card in the system that gets live updated when the contact updates their Google+, Twitter, or LinkedIn profile (no mention of Facebook, however). People is integrated throughout Android 4.0, with "chips" that are mini visual info cards that pop up in Gmail and the phone application.

**Built-in data usage management:** Ice Cream Sandwich finally includes a stock app that gives you granular control over network activity and the ability to view a specific app's data usage. You can even set a warning (for when you cross 1GB, for example) and a hard cap, to make sure you don't pay stupidly excessive overage charges.

## The best new features in Ice Cream Sandwich

Hands down the two most impressive updates were the improvements to the Camera app and the use of NFC for information and app discovery. The Camera app added an impressive panoramic functionality that has pro photos buzzing. ICS (or perhaps ICS when used with the Galaxy Nexus) has zero shutter lag allowing you to take images much faster. Using this upgrade, ICS allows a budding photographer to sweep their phone in a smooth motion at a view they want to capture and creates a panoramic image right inside the handset. The app liter-

ally does everything for the user, takes the necessary images and stitches them together into one panoramic image. The demo of this was very cool indeed.

NFC chips are certainly gaining traction in usefulness in the mobile marketplace. ICS adds some interesting functionality using the relatively new tech. By tapping two handsets with ICS and NFC installed users can trade contact info, Maps directions and app recommendations right between their two systems. You can be playing a game on your ICS handset and if another person pushes their handset up against yours, a link to the game on Android Market magically hops across. The possibilities for NFC use in this way are endless: games of tag, information that is shared when a person checks in some place and other cool ways to put NFC to work.

The source for ICS won't be dropping for a few weeks, but the Android SDK has been updated, so you can play around the emulator if you like. The Android Developers site also has a complete list of Ice Cream Sandwich's key features, if you're interested — and finally, there's an introductory video embedded below. The Galaxy Nexus will drop in the States, Europe, and Asia sometime in November, but the pricing and carrier availability is not yet known.

